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Maths puzzles for early finishers

# Early Finisher Puzzles

## Primary 2

### Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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# Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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## What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 2 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

## Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 2 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

## Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages).

## How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word, and one or two wrong answers very rarely do. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Letters in an order, a grid or a choice.** Each number, card, picture or choice carries a letter; the letters, read in the order asked, must spell a word. Where one item is left out, its letter is a decoy that is not part of the word.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

## How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

# Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

## Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-20) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-13, S2-19) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as comparing amounts of money, lengths of lessons given in hours and minutes and printed facts, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of rulers, scales, clocks, coins and notes are original drawings, not to scale unless a page says so. Coins and notes are inspired by Singapore money, drawn larger than real and in black and white.

## Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Use normal toner, not a light setting: on the coin pages (Dollars and Cents, Purse Match) a light setting can fill in the small word cents on the coins. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

# Contents: Semester 2


| Page | Code | Puzzle | Tier |
|---|---|---|---|
| S2-01 | P2-06 | Dollars and Cents | 1 star |
| S2-02 | P2-16 | Writing Money | 2 stars |
| S2-03 | P2-23 | Which Costs More? | 2 stars |
| S2-04 | P2-24 | Purse Match | 2 stars |
| S2-05 | P2-08 | Metres | 1 star |
| S2-06 | P2-25 | Kilograms and Grams | 1 star |
| S2-07 | P2-26 | Litres | 1 star |
| S2-08 | P2-27 | Which Unit? | 1 star |
| S2-09 | P2-28 | Order the Measures | 2 stars |
| S2-10 | P2-07 | Time to the Minute | 1 star |
| S2-11 | P2-30 | Hours and Minutes | 1 star |
| S2-12 | P2-29 | Match the Times | 2 stars |
| S2-13 | P2-31 | Time Detective | 2 stars |
| S2-14 | P2-32 | Shape Patterns | 1 star |
| S2-15 | P2-33 | Pattern Rules | 2 stars |
| S2-16 | P2-34 | Meet the Solids | 1 star |
| S2-17 | P2-35 | Solid Sort | 2 stars |
| S2-18 | P2-36 | Picture Graph Scales | 1 star |
| S2-19 | P2-37 | Graph Detective Two | 2 stars |
| S2-20 | P2-40 | Colour the Butterfly | 2 stars |


Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P2-01 to P2-40).

## What the booklet covers

**Money 1.1** counting amount of money in dollars and cents **S2-01, S2-04, S2-20**

**Money 1.2** reading and writing money in decimal notation **S2-01, S2-02, S2-03, S2-04, S2-20**

**Money 1.3** comparing two or three amounts of money **S2-03, S2-20**

**Money 1.4** converting an amount of money in decimal notation to cents only, and vice versa **S2-02, S2-20**

**Length, Mass and Volume 1.1** measuring (length in metres; mass in kilograms/grams; volume of liquid in litres) **S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-09**

**Length, Mass and Volume 1.2** using appropriate units of measurement and their abbreviations m, g, kg, ℓ **S2-05, S2-06, S2-07, S2-08**

**Length, Mass and Volume 1.3** comparing and ordering (lengths; masses; volumes) **S2-09**

**Time 2.1** telling time to the minute **S2-10, S2-12, S2-13**

**Time 2.2** measuring time in hours and minutes **S2-13**

**Time 2.3** converting time in hours and minutes to minutes only, and vice versa **S2-11, S2-13**

**2D Shapes 1.1** making/completing patterns with 2D shapes according to one or two of the following attributes (size; shape; colour; orientation) **S2-14, S2-15**

**3D Shapes 2.1** identifying, naming, describing and classifying 3D shapes (cube, cuboid, cone, cylinder, sphere) **S2-16, S2-17**

**Picture Graphs with Scales 1.1** reading and interpreting data from picture graphs with scales **S2-18, S2-19**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.6; Addition and Subtraction 2.1; Addition and Subtraction 2.2; Multiplication and Division 3.1; Multiplication and Division 3.2; Multiplication and Division 3.3; Multiplication and Division 3.4; Multiplication and Division 3.5; Fractions 1.1; Fractions 1.2; Fractions 1.3; Fractions 2.1.

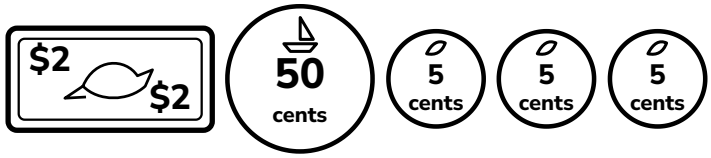
S2-01 (P2-06)

# Dollars and Cents

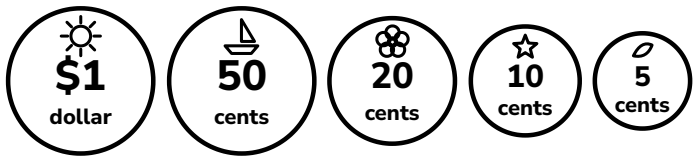
Name _____

**Topic: Money: counting coins and notes, decimal notation**

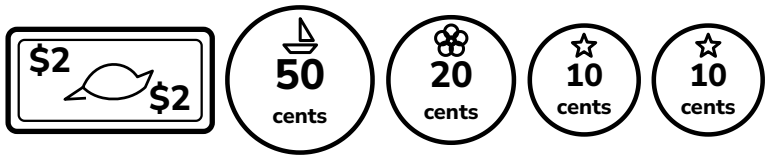
Count the money in each row.
Write the total, like $3.45.
Use the code table.

1. 

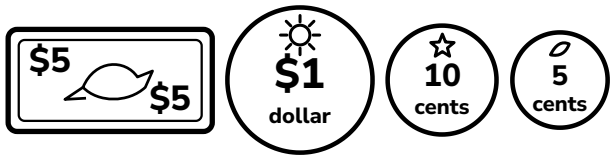
$ ____

2. 

$ ____

3. 

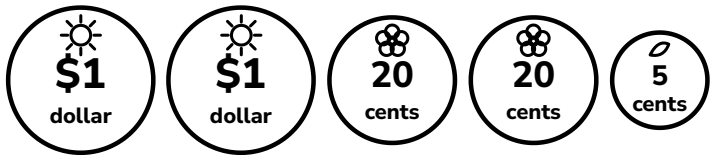
$ ____

4. 

$ ____

5. 

$ ____

6. 

$ ____

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $1.45 = C | $1.85 = A | $2.45 = R | $2.60 = X | $2.65 = S |
| $2.90 = I | $2.95 = Q | $6.10 = V | $6.15 = L | $10.25 = O |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-02 (P2-16)

# Writing Money

★★ Name _____

**Topic: Money: decimal notation and cents**

Write each amount a different way.
Cents: write a number. Dollars: write like $2.50.
Use the code table.

**1** 49¢ = $ ?

$ ☐

**2** $9.37 = ? ¢

☐ ¢

**3** $7.06 = ? ¢

☐ ¢

**4** 604¢ = $ ?

$ ☐

**5** 224¢ = $ ?

$ ☐

**6** 3 dollars and 41 cents = $ ?

$ ☐

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $0.39 = I | $0.49 = M | $1.49 = Q | $2.24 = E | $3.41 = T |
| $5.04 = X | $6.04 = N | 706¢ = G | 937¢ = A | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-03 (P2-23)

# Which Costs More?

★★ Name _____

**Topic: Money: comparing and ordering amounts**

Put the prices in order.
Write the letter of each card in its place.
Set A: lowest first. Set B: highest first.

**Set A: the lowest price first.**

| O | U | B |
|---|---|---|
| bag | pencil case | toy car |
| $6.90 | $6.95 | $6.50 |

**Set B: the highest price first.**

| E | C | N |
|---|---|---|
| cap | bottle | scarf |
| $3.40 | $3.50 | $3.95 |

**Write the letters in order: Set A, then Set B.**

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |

**Check it.** Read the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-04 (P2-24)

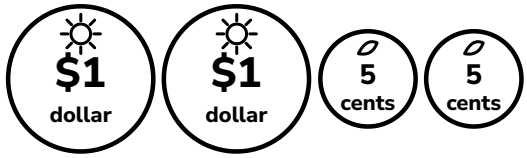
# Purse Match

★★ Name _____

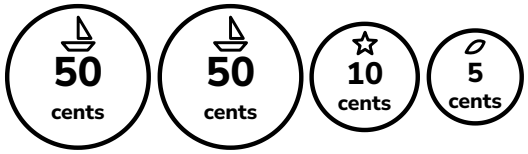
**Topic: Money: counting coins and notes, matching amounts**

Count the money in each purse.
Match each amount to its purse.
Write the letter of the purse.

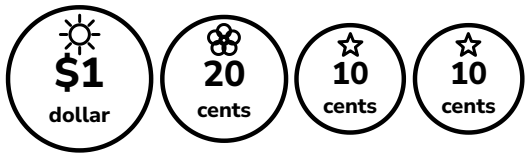
S



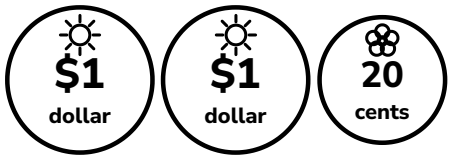

P




C



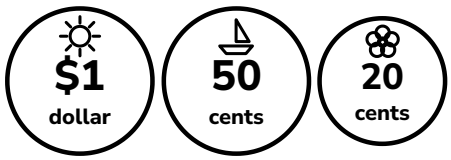

U




A




M




**Which purse holds each amount? Write its letter.**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 **$1.40** ☐ | 2 **$3.00** ☐ | 3 **$1.70** ☐ |
| 4 **$1.15** ☐ | 5 **$2.20** ☐ | 6 **$2.10** ☐ |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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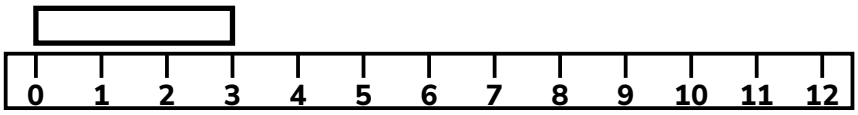
S2-05 (P2-08)

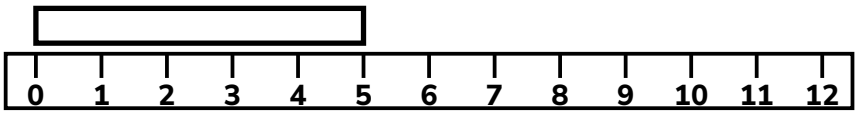
# Metres

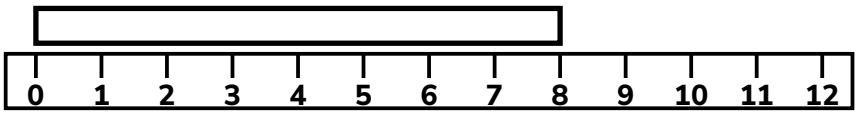
Name _____

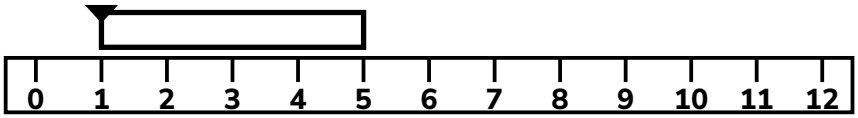
**Topic: Length: measuring in metres (m)**

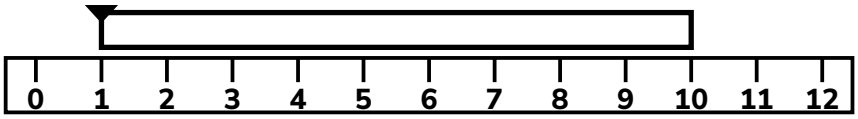
Each tape shows metres.
How long is each thing? Write it in metres.
Use the code table.

1. rope  m

2. wall  m

3. path  m

4. snake  m

5. ribbon  m

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 = Q | 3 = G | 4 = N | 5 = R | 6 = K |
| 7 = Y | 8 = U | 9 = T | 11 = X | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-06 (P2-25)

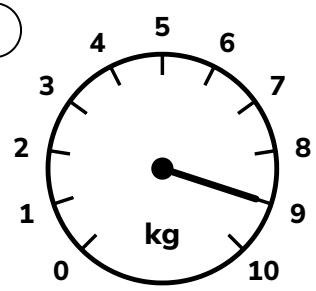
# Kilograms and Grams

★ Name _____

**Topic: Mass: reading scales in kilograms (kg) and grams (g)**

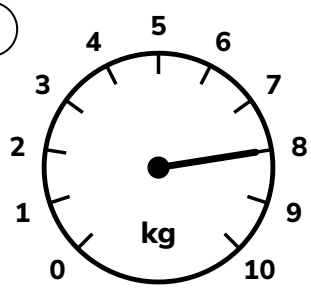
Read each scale.
Write the mass and its unit.
Use the code table.

**1**



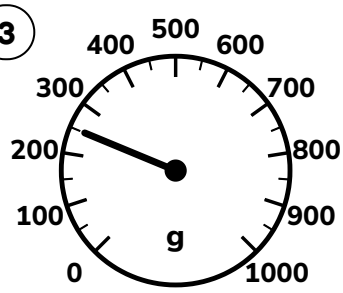

_____ kg

**2**



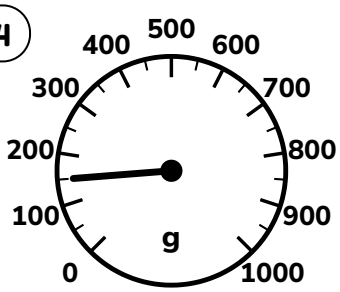

_____ kg

**3**



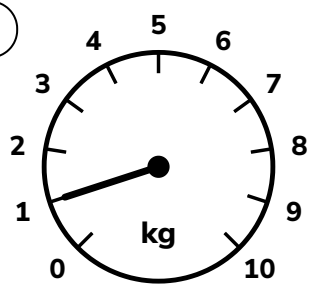

_____ g

**4**



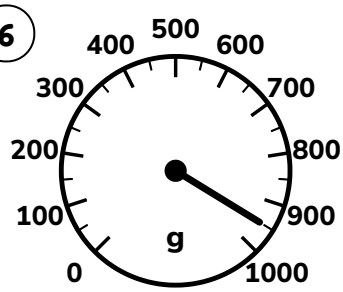

_____ g

**5**




_____ kg

**6**




_____ g

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 kg = R | 3 kg = S | 7 kg = K | 8 kg = I | 9 kg = F |
| 100 g = Z | 150 g = U | 250 g = G | 950 g = E | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-07 (P2-26)

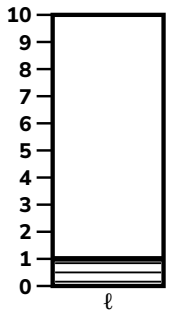
# Litres

Name _____

**Topic: Volume of liquid: reading containers in litres (ℓ)**

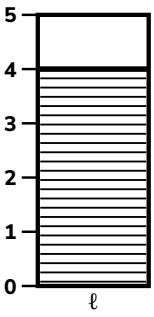
Read the liquid level in each container.
Write the number of litres.
Use the code table.

**1**



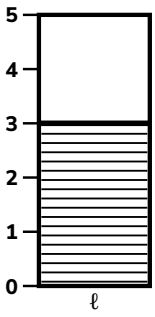

_____ ℓ

**2**



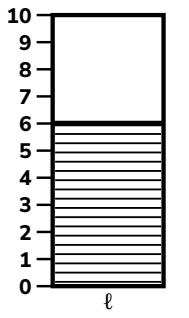

_____ ℓ

**3**



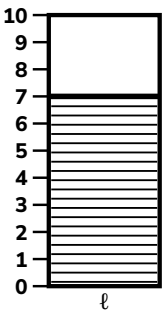

_____ ℓ

**4**



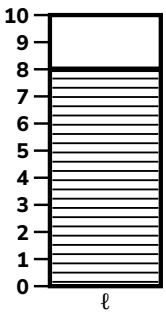

_____ ℓ

**5**




_____ ℓ

**6**




_____ ℓ

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 = Q | 1 = F | 3 = U | 4 = R | 5 = X |
| 6 = I | 7 = T | 8 = Y | 9 = P | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-08 (P2-27)

# Which Unit?

★ Name _____

**Topic: Units of measurement: m, g, kg and ℓ**

Which unit makes sense?
Circle the letter of the right unit.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

1. A boy weighs 25 ___. **kg** (H) **m** (O) **g** (X)

2. An egg weighs 60 ___. **ℓ** (Z) **kg** (T) **g** (U)

3. A bag of rice is 5 ___. **g** (M) **kg** (N) **m** (B)

4. A melon weighs 3 ___. **ℓ** (S) **kg** (G) **m** (V)

5. A bucket holds 8 ___ of water. **g** (I) **ℓ** (R) **m** (X)

6. A pencil weighs 5 ___. **g** (Y) **m** (M) **kg** (E)

**Check it.** Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-09 (P2-28)

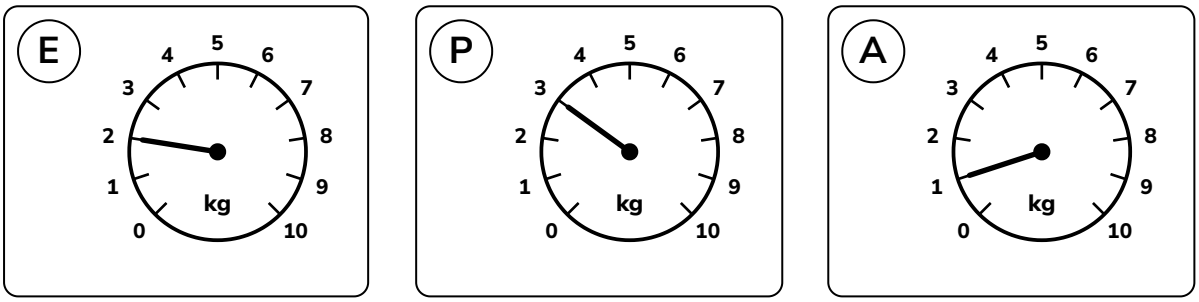
# Order the Measures

★★ Name _____

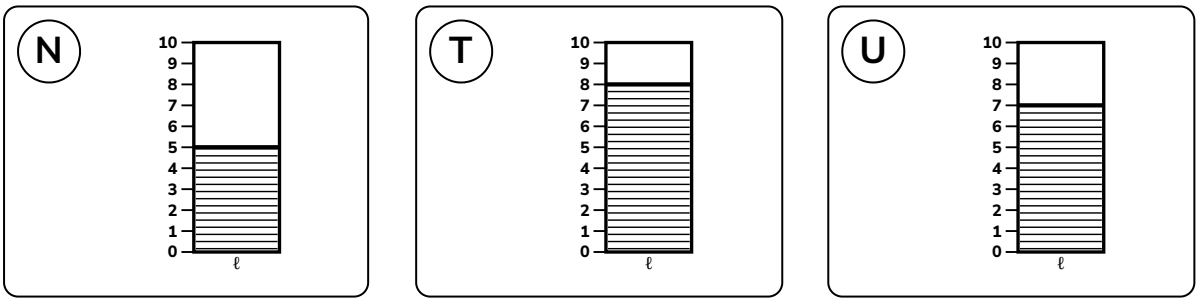
**Topic: Mass and volume: comparing and ordering**

Read each scale and container.
Put each set in order.
Write the letters in order.

**Set A: heaviest first.**




**Set B: least liquid first.**




**Write the letters in order: Set A, then Set B.**

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |

**Check it.** Read the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-10 (P2-07)

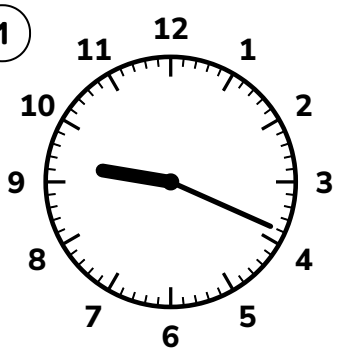
# Time to the Minute

Name _____

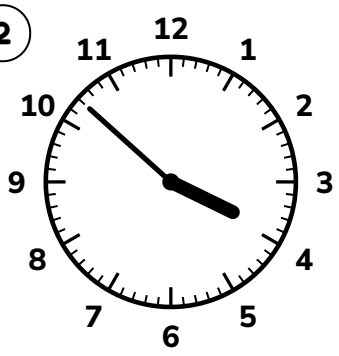
**Topic: Time: telling time to the minute**

Read each clock.
Write the time, like 3:47.
Use the code table.

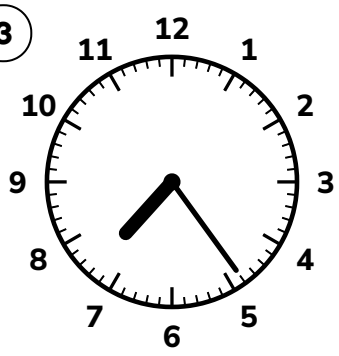
1



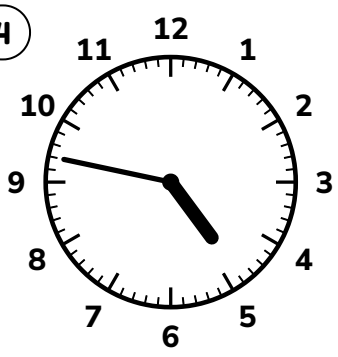
2



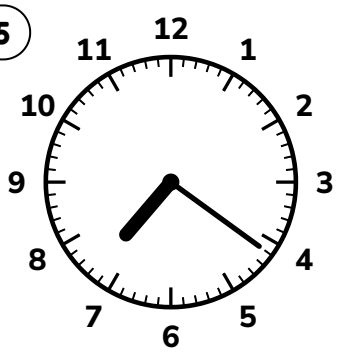
3



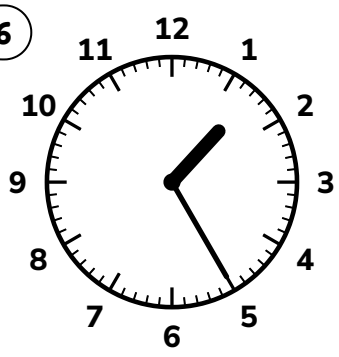
4



5



6



**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1:25 = P | 3:45 = Q | 3:52 = E | 4:47 = C | 4:52 = J |
| 5:05 = K | 7:19 = R | 7:21 = U | 7:24 = A | 9:19 = T |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word?

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S2-11 (P2-30)

# Hours and Minutes

★ Name _____

**Topic: Time: changing hours and minutes to minutes, and back**

1 h = 60 min.

Fill in the missing number.

Use the code table.

**1** 3 h 30 min = ? min

☐ min

**2** 250 min = ? h 10 min

☐ h

**3** 3 h = ? min

☐ min

**4** 270 min = 4 h ? min

☐ min

**5** 1 h 25 min = ? min

☐ min

**6** 185 min = 3 h ? min

☐ min

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 = O | 5 = E | 30 = G | 33 = B | 85 = U |
| 180 = N | 210 = T | 240 = H | 300 = X | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-12 (P2-29)

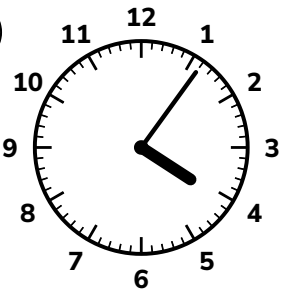
# Match the Times

★★ Name _____

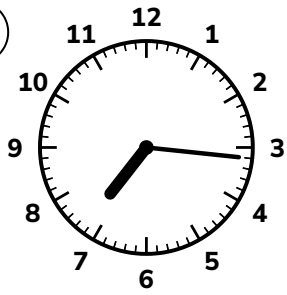
**Topic: Time: matching clocks and times to the minute**

Read each clock.
Match each time to its clock.
Write the letter of the clock.

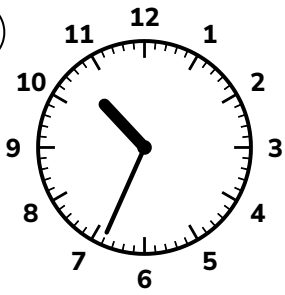
A



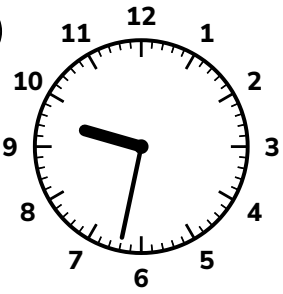
W



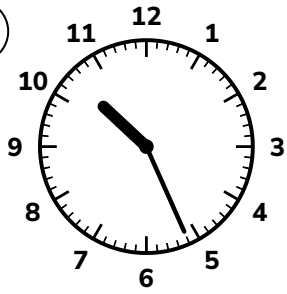
O



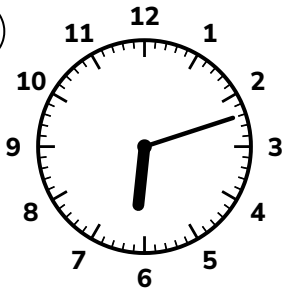
S



H



D



**Which clock shows each time? Write its letter.**

1. **9:32** ☐
2. **10:26** ☐
3. **4:06** ☐
4. **6:12** ☐
5. **10:34** ☐
6. **7:16** ☐

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-13 (P2-31)

# Time Detective

★★ Name _____

**Topic: Time: a timetable with hours and minutes**

Read the timetable.
Answer each question.
Use the code table.

| Lesson | Starts | Lasts |
|---|---|---|
| **Art** | 8:30 am | 45 min |
| **Science** | 9:30 am | 1 h 25 min |
| **Drawing** | 11:10 am | 1 h 5 min |
| **Reading** | 12:25 pm | 1 h 5 min |
| **Music** | 1:35 pm | 1 h 25 min |
| **Maths** | 3:10 pm | 35 min |

1. How many minutes does Art last? ☐

2. How many minutes does Science last? ☐

3. How many minutes do Maths and Reading last together? ☐

4. Drawing starts at 11:10 am. How many minutes past the hour? ☐

5. How many lessons start before 10:00 am? ☐

6. Music lasts more than 1 h. How many minutes more than 1 h? ☐

**Code table**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **2 = I** | **7 = G** | **10 = D** | **12 = X** |
| **25 = T** | **45 = B** | **85 = A** | **100 = N** |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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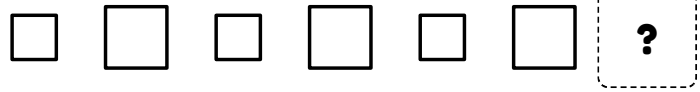
S2-14 (P2-32)

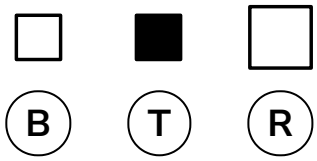
# Shape Patterns

Name _____

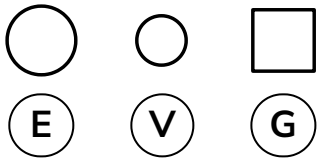
**Topic: 2D shape patterns: what comes next?**

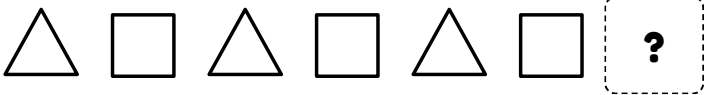
Look at each pattern.
Circle the letter of the shape that comes next.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

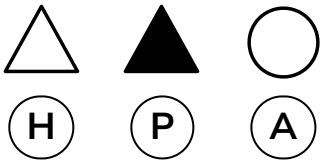
1 



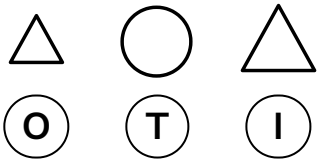

2 



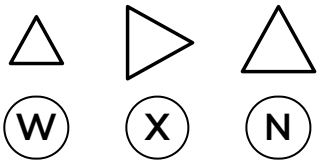

3 

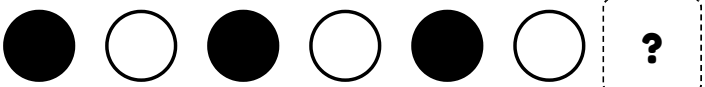


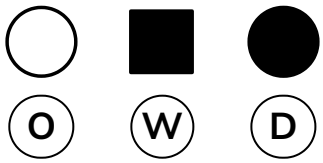

4 




5 




6 




**Check it.** Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-15 (P2-33)

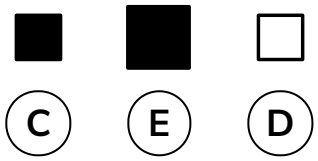
# Pattern Rules

★★ Name _____

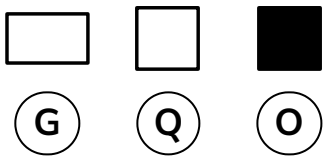
**Topic: 2D shape patterns: what comes next?**

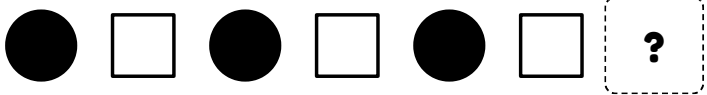
Look at each pattern.
Circle the letter of the shape that comes next.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

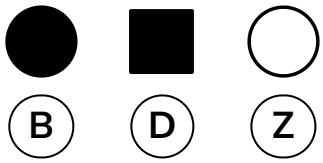
1 

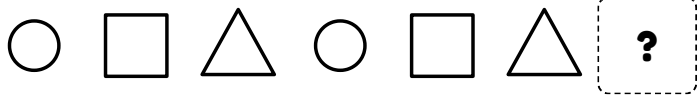


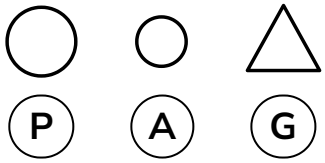

2 



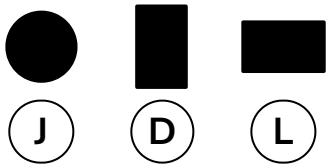

3 

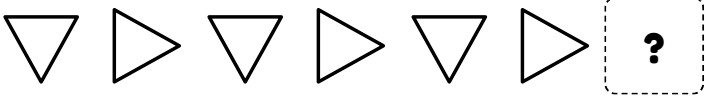


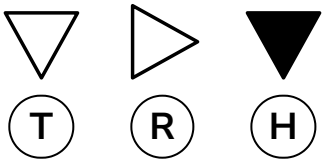

4 




5 




6 




**Check it.** Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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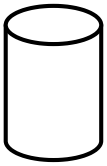
S2-16 (P2-34)

# Meet the Solids

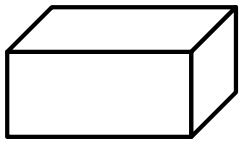
Name _____

**Topic: 3D shapes: cube, cuboid, cone, cylinder and sphere**

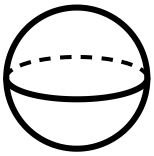
Name each solid.
Circle the letter of its name.
Write the six letters in the boxes.

1 

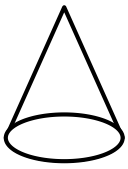
**cuboid** (G) **cylinder** (B) **cone** (F)

2 

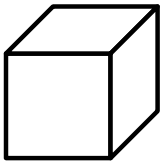
**cuboid** (A) **cube** (S) **sphere** (H)

3 

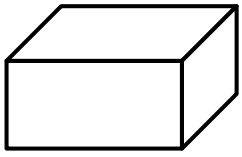
**sphere** (C) **cube** (W) **cylinder** (T)

4 

**cylinder** (Q) **cuboid** (V) **cone** (K)

5 

**cube** (U) **cone** (Z) **cuboid** (T)

6 

**cuboid** (P) **cube** (J) **cone** (T)

**Check it.** Write the six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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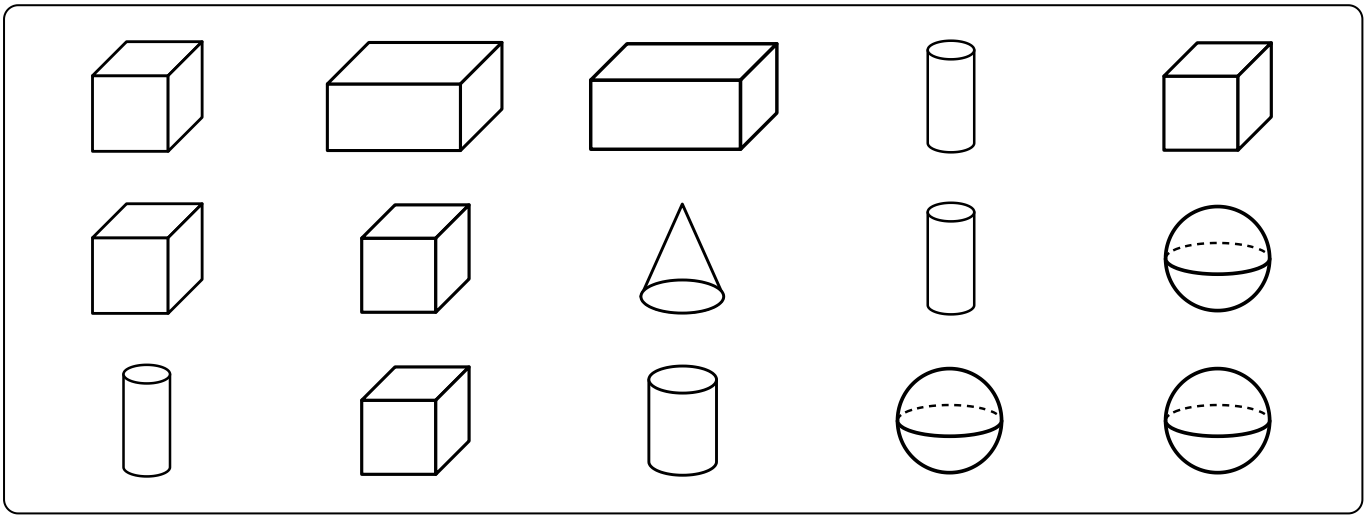
S2-17 (P2-35)

# Solid Sort

★★ Name _____

**Topic: 3D shapes: sorting and counting solids**

Count each kind of solid.
Write the number in its box.
Use the code table.



**How many of each? Total: 15.**

| cube | cuboid | cone | cylinder | sphere |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |

**Code table**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 = I | 2 = H | 3 = F | 4 = E |
| 5 = T | 6 = J | 7 = G | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? Do the counts add to 15?

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S2-18 (P2-36)

# Picture Graph Scales

★ Name _____

**Topic: Picture graphs with scales: one picture stands for more than one**

Read the key. One picture is more than 1.
Answer each question.
Use the code table.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Blue** |  |
| **Yellow** |  |
| **Black** |  |
| **Green** |  |
| **Red** |  |

**Key:**  **= 2 children**

1. How many children chose Blue? ☐
2. How many children chose Yellow? ☐
3. How many fewer chose Black than Green? ☐
4. How many children chose Green or Red? ☐
5. How many children in all? ☐
6. How many more chose Yellow than Red? ☐

**Code table**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 = Y | 8 = N | 10 = O | 14 = D | 18 = Q |
| 20 = K | 22 = G | 52 = E | 54 = B | |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-19 (P2-37)

# Graph Detective Two ★★

Name _____

**Topic: Picture graphs with scales: two rows are covered**

Two rows are covered.
Use the clues. Answer each question.
Use the code table.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Melons** |  |
| **Plums** |  |
| **Pears** |  |
| **Mangoes** | **covered** |
| **Lychees** | **covered** |

**Key:**  **= 10 children**

- There are 2 pictures for Lychees (covered).
- The graph shows 200 children in all.

1. How many pictures for Mangoes? ☐
2. How many children chose Mangoes? ☐
3. How many children chose Lychees? ☐
4. How many fewer chose Melons than Mangoes? ☐
5. How many more chose Plums than Lychees? ☐
6. How many children in all? ☐

**Code table**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **4 = F** | **9 = S** | **10 = I** | **20 = M** |
| **30 = L** | **40 = A** | **41 = J** | **200 = Y** |

**Check it.** Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? Do the rows add to the total? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-20 (P2-40)

# Colour the Butterfly

★★ Name _____

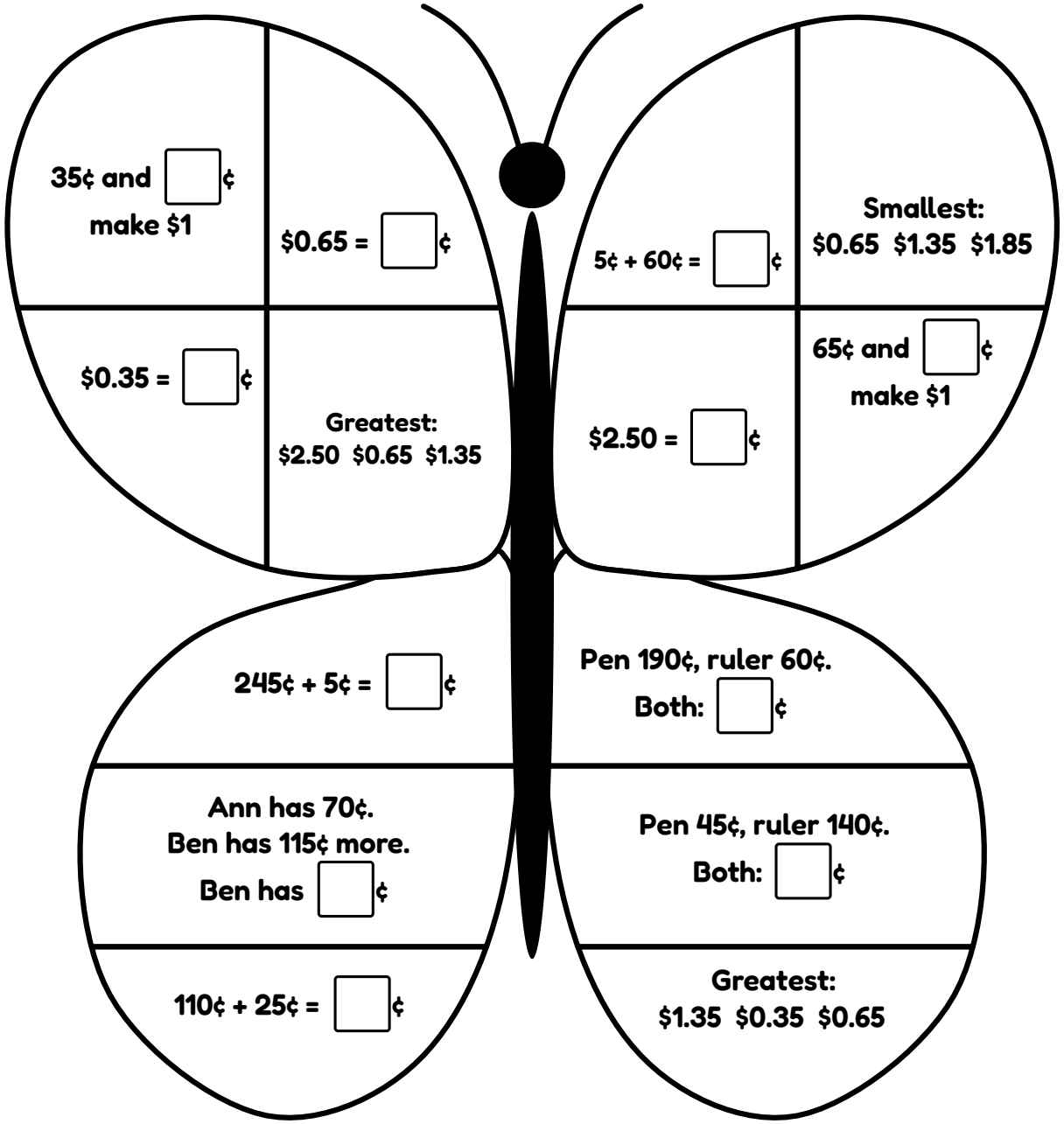
**Topic: Money: cents and dollars, decimal notation**

Work out the answer in each part.

Find it in the key.

Colour the part. No crayon? Write Y, R, B, G or O.

| 35¢ | 65¢ | 135¢ | 185¢ | 250¢ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| yellow | red | blue | green | orange |




**Check it.**

Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 4, blue 2, green 2, orange 4.

Parts in the same place on the left and on the right have the same colour.

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